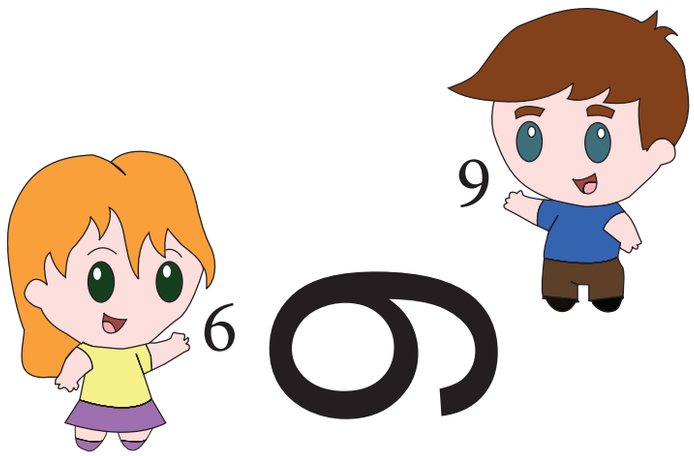
14.2 Scripting Language

A scripting language is a programming language designed for integrating and communicating with other programming languages. Some of the most widely used scripting languages are JavaScript, VBScript, PHP, Perl, Python, Ruby, ASP and Tcl. Since a scripting language is normally used in conjunction with another programming language, they are often found alongside HTML, Java or C++.

14.2.1 Difference between Scripting and Programming Languages

Scripting Language and Programming Language looks like the following picture.



Basically, all scripting languages are programming languages. The theoretical difference between the two is that scripting languages do not require the compilation step and are rather interpreted. For example, normally, a C++ program needs to be compiled before running whereas, a scripting language like JavaScript or Python need not be compiled. A scripting language requires an interpreter while a programming language requires a compiler. A given language can be called as a scripting or programming language depending on the environment they are put to use.

14.3 Applications of Scripting Languages

1. To automate certain tasks in a program
2. Extracting information from a data set
3. Less code intensive as compared to traditional programming language
4. can bring new functions to applications and glue complex systems together

Python is actually an interpreted, high-level, general-purpose programming language that can be used on any modern computer operating system. It can be used for processing text, numbers, images, scientific data and just about anything else you might save on a computer. Now a days, large applications are written almost exclusively in Python.

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